

ANCIENT HISTORY



MODULE - 20

GUPTA DYNASTY
PART - 3

OUR APPROACH TO FIND HISTORY FROM MYSTERY?

PRE - HISTORY

The period of time before written records.

- Stone Age
- Metal Age

PROTO - HISTORY

IVC

Aryan Invasion

VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 500 B.C.)

EARLY VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 1000 B.C.)

LATER VEDIC AGE
(1000 – 500 B.C.)

RELIGION & PHILOSOPHY



JAINISM



BUDDHISM

HISTORIC PERIOD

MAHAJANAPADAS

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

MAGADHA

NANDA DYNASTY

Alexander Invasion

MAURYAN DYNASTY

MAURYAN DYNASTY

GUPTA DYNASTY

Foreign Invasion

KUSHAN EMPIRE

SATAVAHANAS

PUSHYABHUTHI DYNASTY

Huns Invasion

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS

SANGAM AGE

CHOLA

CHERA

PANDYA

MAUKHARIS

VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS



GUPTA DYNASTY

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

ECONOMY

1 PRIMARY ECONOMY

- **Agriculture** was the main occupation in Gupta Empire and there was no governmental interference.
- The land was fertile and means of **irrigation** were simple.



2 SECONDARY ECONOMY

- **Cloth centers and silk industry** (Mandsor Inscriptions) witnessed a significant development.
- **Ornaments industry** used silver, gold and copper to make ornaments.
- Pearl industry
- Pottery industry



GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

ECONOMY

3

TERTIARY ECONOMY

GUILD SYSTEM

- Merchants organized guilds to increase their activities. They were known as **Sarthavaha**.
- In Gupta age activities of guilds increased.
- However they declined after Gupta period. The **guilds of merchants and artisans** were governed by their own laws .

In ancient history, the glimpses of guild systems are seen in Jatakas Tales.

COINS AND CURRENCY

- Gold, silver and Copper coins.
- **More of gold coins** indicates flourishing economy
- **Coins of Chandragupta depict Garuda preying a snake.**
- **Coins of samudragupta depict him playing Veena which shows his keen interest in music.**



GUPTA EMPIRE

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ECONOMY

3

TERTIARY ECONOMY

TRADE

Trade with Romans (known as Byzantine Empire), Ethiopia, Persia, Arabia.



Trade with East Asia and Sri Lanka.

Trade with China for Chinese silk.

Major export commodities include- Cotton cloths (bengal), Silk (benaras), Spices and sandal(south), Indigo (Bihar), Sents of Himalayas, Leather goods, Fur, Iron Products, Ivory, pearl etc.



MAJOR EXPORT COMMODITIES



SILK AND COTTON



PEARLS



SANDALWOOD



HIMALAYAN SENTS



LEATHER



SPICES

MAJOR IMPORT COMMODITIES



HORSES



CHINESE SILK



ETHIOPIAN IVORY



COPPER



LEAD



GOLD

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

ECONOMY

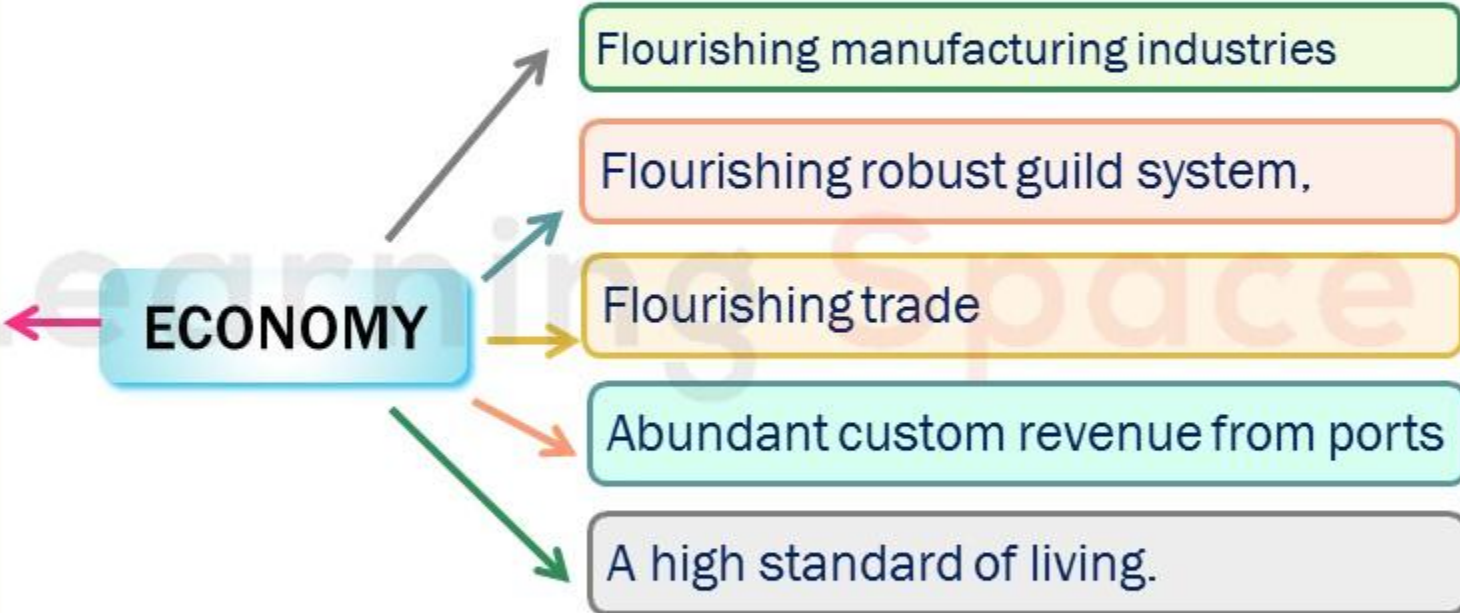
SALIENT FEATURES OF GUPTA ECONOMY- IN SHORT

FLOURISHING AGRICULTURAL

Various taxes imposed

- Bali: was voluntary in Maurya era became compulsory in Gupta Era.
- Bhaga: Royal share in all produce which was 1/6th part of produce.
- Bhoga: refers to the tax in kind of gifts, flowers, woods, fruits etc.
- Hiranya: This was the tax paid in cash (Gold) {Hiranya means Gold}

ECONOMY



Flourishing manufacturing industries

Flourishing robust guild system,

Flourishing trade

Abundant custom revenue from ports

A high standard of living.

Economy which was badly affected in later periods due to Huna invasions

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

DECLINE

HUNS INVASION

What enable the
HUNS to topple
the mighty
GUPTA empire?

Excelled in **Horsemanship**
possibly due to use of
stirrups made of metal.
They could move quickly

Being **excellent archers**

- Huns were central Asian tribes.
- Toramana, the most popular king who was tyrant and iconoclast.
- Kalhana in Rajtarangini and Huien Tsang mentioned him as **persecutor of Buddhist**. Banabata in his Harshacharitra also refers to the Huns invasions as the cause of decline of Guptas.



Guptas lost western India due to Huns invasion which crippled foreign trade.



Yasodharman in Malwa was one of the feudatory of Gupta. He successfully checked Huns advances and defeated the last gupta ruler.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

DECLINE

THREE IMPORTANT REASONS

**DECLINE IN
ECONOMIC PROSPERITY**

Migration of silk
weaver guild to
Malwa region

Cripples
Mauryan
economy

**HUNS
INVASION**

DECLINE

**RISE OF
FEUDATORIES**

Land grant on
large scale
reduced their
revenues.

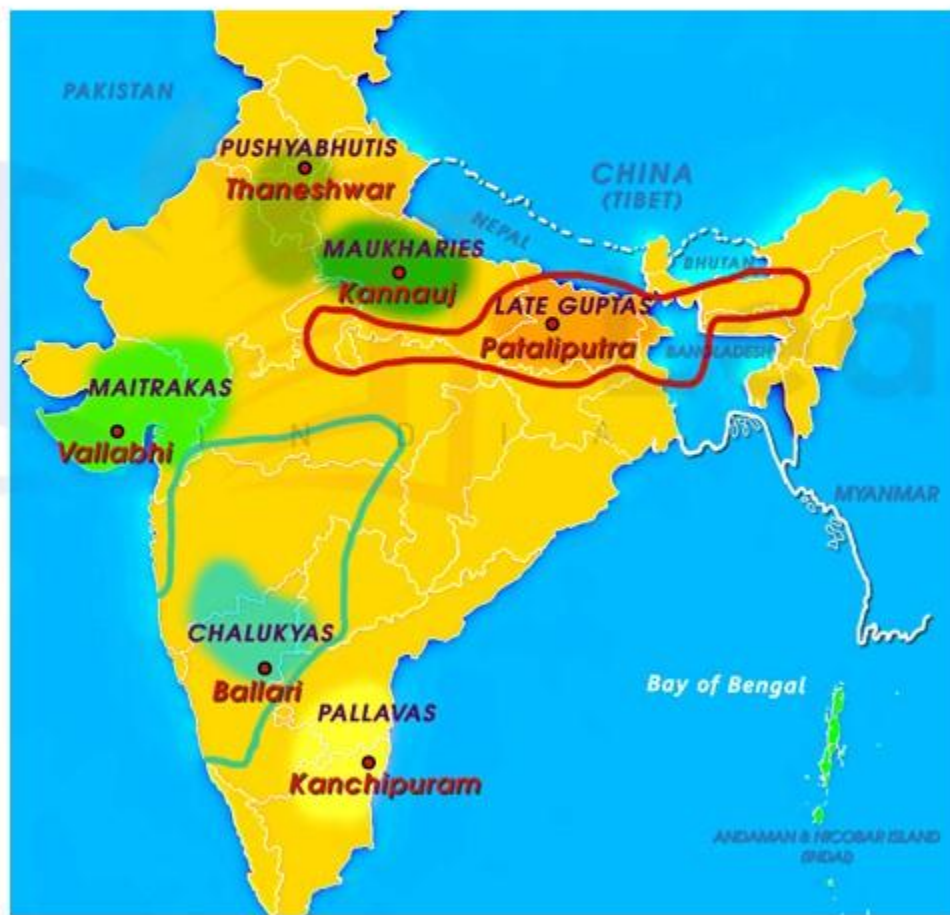
Decline is indicated by gold coins of later Gupta period which have less of gold content and more of alloy.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

DECLINE

SUCCESSOR KINGDOM



1

Pushyabhutis of Thaneshwar

2

Maukharies of Kannauj

3

Maitrakas of Vallabhi

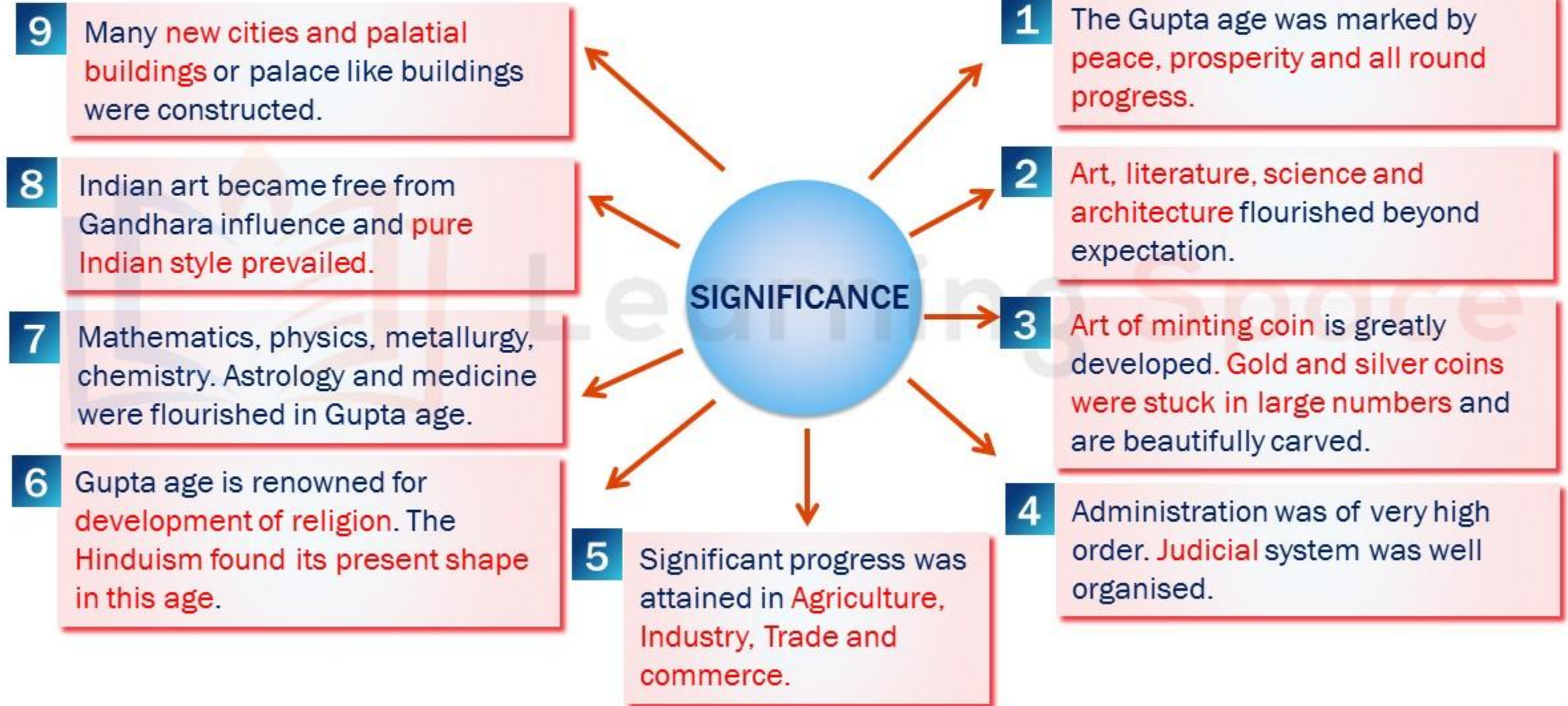
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Chalukyas and Pallavas emerged as strong regional empire in Deccan and northern Tamil Nadu respectively.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SIGNIFICANCE



GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

OTHER FACTS

1 STATE SEAL

GARUDA was probably their state seal.



2 WHY GUPTAS SUPPORTED BRAHMANAS?

1 The brahmanas represented the Gupta kings as possessing the attributes of gods, and the Gupta princes became great supporters of the brahmanical order.

2 The Guptas who were originally vaishyas and came to be looked upon as kshatriyas by the brahmanas in turn they accumulated wealth on account of numerous land grants and claimed many privileges, which are listed in the law-book of Narada.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

OTHER FACTS



3 JUNAGARH INSCRIPTION

1 Mentions about 4 kings who repaired SUDARSHAN lake.

- 2**
- Chandragupta Maurya, constructed the lake.
 - Ashoka (Mauryan dynasty),
 - Rudradaman (Shaka dynasty) and
 - Skandagupta (Gupta empire)

Q & A

Q.1 With reference to the guilds (*shreni*) of ancient India that played a very important role in the country's economy, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Every guild was registered with the central authority of the state and the king was the chief admin authority on them.
2. The wages, rules of work, standards and prices were fixed by the guild
3. The guild had judicial powers over its own members.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER

d)

Q & A

Q.2 The region of Gupta age is known as “Golden age of India”. Which of the following is true in this regard.

- a) There was religious tolerance
- b) There was peace and prosperity
- c) There was tremendous advancement in the field of science.
- d) All of the above

ANSWER

d)

Q & A

Q.3 Which was the most important factor in transforming ancient Indian society into Feudal society?

- a) Decline of trade
- b) Proliferation of caste
- c) Practices of Land grants
- d) None of the above

ANSWER c)

THOUGHT PROVOKING QUESTIONS

- Q.1** Why there was so much scientific advancements during gupta period
- Q.2** Why Mauryans adopted centralised system and Guptas adopted decentralised system
- Q.3** Write a short essay on “origin and meaning of samanta system”
- Q.4** Throw light on the condition of women during the gupta period and compare with the present society.

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